

Day 2 — Defining the North Star Metric · Facilitator Guide

Companion to `labs/day-02-north-star.md`. Facilitator-only — do not hand to participants. Cues, answer keys, timings, reflections.

Activity 1 — Three Pitfalls Triage

Cues:

- The "Songs Saved to Library" card is the trickiest — it sounds clean, but a user can save songs they never listen to. Probe.
- "ARR" almost always gets all three — push triads to name *why* it's a financial result, not a customer outcome.

Answer key / watch-for: In the 8-card example pack, "Songs Saved to Library" (card 4) is the intended trap — reads clean but is gameable/vanity-prone. "Annual Recurring Revenue" (card 6) is the intended all-three-pitfalls card. Don't reveal these; steer triads to reason their way there.

Activity 2 — Re-write Your NS

Cues:

- Triads that converge too quickly often skipped the pitfall test. Re-anchor on disagreement.
- The counter-metric is the new concept and the most under-practiced. Walk the room verifying each triad has a concrete one, not "we'd watch retention generally."

Activity 3 — The "CEO and Dispatcher" Test

Cues:

- Commit to the persona. Half-hearted role-play surfaces nothing.
- If a challenger softens when they like the NS, swap challenger and defender mid-round to recalibrate.

Activity 4 — NS Lock-in + Tier Sheet Refresh

Cues:

- Pin the NS Defense Cards alongside the Tier Sheets. Both stay up all week.
- Watch for triads that lock without walking down/up. If signals or KPIs don't ladder anymore, the NS swap broke the chain.

Facilitator reflection prompts (end of day)

- Which triad's NS still smells like ARR-in-disguise? They get coached first tomorrow.

- Which triad's counter-metric is doing the most work? Surface it as a positive example next week.
- Was anyone missing the "single number" requirement? That's the loosest check participants self-apply — tighten it tomorrow if needed.